

Minor scales

Just like a major scale, a minor scale is also a series of notes rising and falling within the range of an octave. But a minor scale takes some of the notes of a major scale and lowers them by a half step.

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◀ 60–61 Major scales

Keys

64–67 ▶

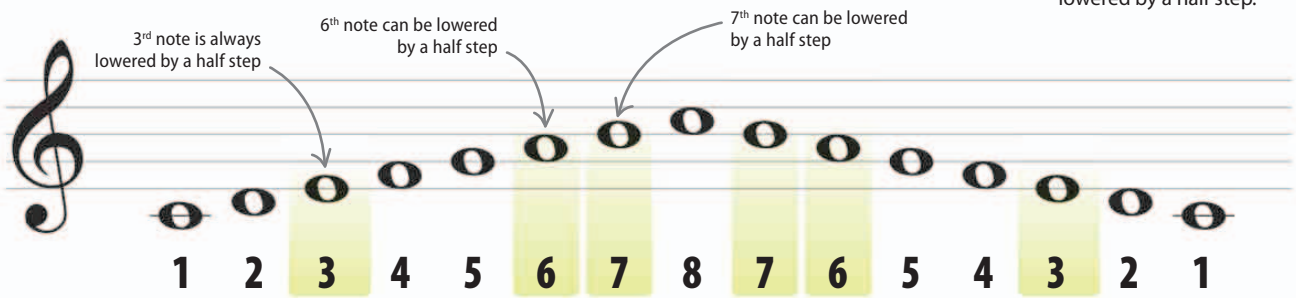
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From major to minor

There are three main types of minor scales: natural minor, harmonic minor, and melodic minor. The 3rd, 6th, and 7th notes of a major scale can be lowered by a half step in a minor scale that starts on the same note.

▽ C major and C minor

In a C minor scale, E (3rd note), A (6th note), and B (7th note) from the C major scale can be lowered by a half step.



The natural minor scale

In the natural minor scale, the 3rd, 6th, and 7th notes of the major scale starting on the same note are all lowered by a half step going up and down the scale.

Whole step
Half step

▽ C natural minor scale

In the natural minor scale starting on C, E becomes E $\flat$, A becomes A $\flat$, and B becomes B $\flat$.

39 ▽ Pattern of the scale
This pyramid shows the pattern of the natural minor scales and how it is broken down into whole steps and half steps.

